



An interview with the Facebook team, on how it caters to growing demands, and addresses them on pg. 72. For the full interview visit:
dvwx.in/mar-12-fb

The battle for an open web

The world of open web standards, and browser vendors is in a storm over the approach that browser vendors might choose to break from the WebKit monoculture. Since the controversy involves vendor prefixes in CSS, so some knowledge of vendor prefixes is essential in understanding the conundrum at hand. For a comparison, go to <http://dvwx.in/Av28Xv>.

Vendor Prefixes

Web standards that browsers implement go through a long gestation process in which the correct way to implement each feature is considered. For something to become a recommendation though, there needs to be two compatible implementations of that standard in browsers.

For the web to progress and evolve, it is also important for browsers to experiment and come up with new features that would be cool to have on the web. These are often only implemented in one browser initially,

then proposed to the standards committee and finally adopted, or rejected by all browsers.

In this initial phase, the feature might be in different browsers, but implemented in a way that is incompatible with other browsers. Hence, a vendor prefix is added. Let's consider CSS3 gradients, for example.

While incompatible, and non-standard, the CSS gradients property could be called `-webkit-gradient` in WebKit browsers, `-moz-gradient` in Mozilla / Gecko browsers, `-ms-gradient` for Internet Explorer, `-o-gradient` for Opera, and `-khtml-gradient` for KHTML browsers (Konqueror).

Different browsers can experiment with different syntax; when it becomes standardised across browsers, the `-webkit-`, or `-moz-` bit is dropped.

The Conundrum

Due to a majority of mobile browser engines being based on WebKit, a lot of websites are built only for WebKit browsers and as such only include the



`-webkit-` bit, even if that feature is supported in other browsers.

Now WebKit developers are unlikely to drop the prefixes and other browser vendors such as Mozilla, Opera, and Microsoft have few options and are actually considering adding `-webkit-` prefix to their own browsers just to have those sites working again.

Obviously, a lot of people are unhappy with this; but the fact of the matter is that the situation is bad enough that there are few other options left. >

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*PSD.js

>>psd.js is a file parser for PSD files created in Photoshop. Given a PSD file, it can parse out information such as image size and color modes, and image contents.

<http://dvwx.in/AfM3cf>

*Ultimate CSS Gradient Generator

>> Yes, that's right; you no longer need to add images to get gradients on your web page. With this service by Colorzilla, you can embed gradients directly as CSS.

<http://dvwx.in/xLZ2vN>



*Seriously.js

>>Seriously.js is a real-time, node-based video compositor for the web. Inspired by professional software such as After Effects and Nuke, Seriously.js renders high-quality video effects.

<http://dvwx.in/y0vz3c>

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*Tablet with KDE Plasma Active announced

>> Spark is an open source, 7-inch tablet. The hardware used by the tablet is unlocked (for hacking fans) and additional features/apps/ productivity will be provided through 'an open content and services market'.

<http://dvwx.in/xCi1WT>



*ReactOS announces version 0.3.14

>>An open source implementation of the popular Windows environment:

<http://dvwx.in/xIYwxe>

*Dartium: Chrome with Dart releases

>> Google has announced a new version of Chromium browser with Dart, an alternative to JavaScript. Dart gives Chromium the flexibility to either run in a virtual machine, or even be compiled into JavaScript, that is commonly used among all browsers in use currently. The new browser is called Dartium, and is available for Windows and Mac:

<http://dvwx.in/wozrow>



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